

Abdullah Al Zahid

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SUMMARY

Civil engineer with a master's degree in transportation engineering, currently an Assistant Planner with the City of Toronto. Reviews engineering submissions and drawings against City standards, analyzes operational data to find where performance can improve, and coordinates across municipal divisions and agencies.

EXPERIENCE

Assistant Planner, Transportation Planning

City of Toronto | January 2024 – present

- Review engineering submissions, consultant studies and drawings against City standards, and recommend conditions where something is missing.
- Analyze large volumes of travel and network data for trends, gaps and emerging issues, and turn them into KPIs and data-driven recommendations.
- Run assigned projects from scoping through to recommendations, planning the work, holding the schedule and quality myself, and reporting progress to the people relying on it.
- Coordinate with divisions, consultants, applicants and outside agencies whose priorities conflict, and work issues through to a position everyone can act on.
- Research policy questions as they come up, looking at how City policy, provincial legislation and work by other levels of government bear on them.
- Write the briefing notes, memos and presentations that carry issues, options and recommendations to senior staff across divisions.

Transportation Planner, Simulation and Modelling

Metrolinx, Service Design | February 2023 – January 2024

- Ran OpenTrack simulations of GO rail services to establish what proposed operating and infrastructure changes would do to run times, reliability and recovery before they were taken forward.
- Built the Crew Variance Tool, a Python application that read large JSON operations files and produced summaries of speed profiles and run-time variance across subdivisions.
- Set up a command line workflow so temporary and permanent slow orders could be pre-simulated in batches, cutting turnaround on scenario requests from days to hours.
- Worked with schedulers, operations staff and engineers to settle the variables a service plan had to be built on.

Graduate Transportation Planner

Mott MacDonald | January – February 2023

- Short consulting placement on Ontario Line work. Ran traffic simulations to estimate how construction staging would affect surrounding streets, and prepared the supporting material for the project team.

Graduate Research Assistant

University of Alberta | January 2020 – August 2022

- Master's research on how road networks perform during emergency evacuations, using macroscopic (LWR) and agent-based (MATSim) models.
- Worked with large travel datasets and wrote up results for readers without a modelling background.

SKILLS

Review of engineering submissions, drawings and specifications. Operational data analysis and continuous improvement. Project planning and follow-through. Coordination with municipal divisions and agencies. Python (Pandas, NumPy), SQL, ArcGIS and QGIS. MS Office.

EDUCATION

MSc, Transportation Engineering — University of Alberta, 2022

BSc, Civil Engineering — Bangladesh University of Engineering and Technology, 2018

BSc, Computer Science — University of British Columbia, in progress (2025–2027)